

The CD-ROM Drives at a Glance									
Brand	Model	Speed	Contact	Phone	E-mail	Web site	Warranty	Price	Rating
Acer	CD652P	52x	Acer Peripherals	022-570 5230/31/32	pankajpamani@acercm.com.tw	www.acercm.com	1 year	Rs 1,650	B+
Acer	CD 656A	56x	Acer Peripherals	022-570 5230/31/32	pankajpamani@acercm.com.tw	www.acercm.com	1 year	Rs 1,850	B+
Apex	CHI-56	56x	Apex Computers	8354157	bomapex@bom2.vsnl.net.in	--	1 year	Rs 1,950	B+
ASUS	CD-S500/G	50x	Aditya Infotech Ltd	6338555to 61	applmbb@bom4.vsnl.net.in	www.adityagroup.com	1 year	Rs 2,250	A-
ASUS	CD-S520G/A	52x	Aditya Infotech Ltd	6338555to 61	applmbb@bom4.vsnl.net.in	www.adityagroup.com	1 year	Rs 2,350	B+
Creative	Digital iR	52x	Compuage Infocom Ltd	022-8305501/02/03	info@compuageindia.com	www.compuageindia.com	1 year	Rs 2,250	B
Krypton		52x	Priya International	022-2663611	prom@priyagroup.com	www.priyagroup.com	1 year	Rs 1,740	B+
LG	LG CRD-8522B	52x	LG Electronics	022-691 0123	sarjaym@lgindia.com	www.lgindia.com	1 year	Rs 2,200	B+
Plextor	PX-40TSi	40x	Zeta Technology	022-4102288	tejas@zetaindia.com	www.zetaindia.com	1 year	Rs 5,450	B
Samsung	SC-152	52x	Savex Computers Ltd	022- 2881616/17	devang@savexcomputers.com	www.savexcomputers.com	1 year	Rs 2,000	B

2000 points, another drive that delivered below-par performance in this test was the Krypton 52x, which just managed a score of 1380 in spite of being rated as a 52x drive.

If you more often than not run applications from the CD drive directly (as in games that need the CD to be in the drive to be played) and also perform extensive installations, then the ASUS CD-S520, which did well in this test, would be your best choice. If price is a constraint, then you could consider the Apex CHI-56, which delivered performance close to the best performer in this test, but was priced lower.

Give me raw numbers!

SiSoft Sandra (System Analyser, Diagnostic and Reporting Assistant) 2001te is a utility that we used to benchmark parameters such as sequential read, which is important while copying or playing back a single large data file, such as an MPG or AVI file, from your CD.

The random read, buffer read and the access time of the CD drive that this test measures are also important because they reflect the performance while browsing the contents of a CD. This test also logs information such as the maximum speed the drive reached while run-

ning the test.

Here too ASUS delivered exemplary performance in both, the 52x and 50x drive categories. Results logged by the **ASUS CD-S520/G** were very impressive across the board where it logged a sequential read speed of 3553 KBps, a random speed of 682 KBps and an access time of 56 ms. These were among the highest that we've seen in a CD-ROM drive. This performance was also replicated by its 50x sibling, which clocked a sequential read score of 3496 KBps, a random read speed of 688 KBps and an access time of 55ms.

Another drive that also did especially well in this test was the Apex CHI-56, which scored 3395 KBps in the sequential read test. The random read speed and the access time of this 56x rated drive, which was clocked at 764 KBps and 45 ms, respectively, turned out to be even faster than that of ASUS.

On the other side of the spectrum, the drive that disappointed was the Samsung SC-152. It managed a sequential read

speed of just 1462 KBps, which is under par considering that it is a 52x drive. To add to this, the price of this drive was a shade higher than the average pricing in the 52x category.

The Creative Digital iR CD drive was another that gave a low result of 2061 KBps in the sequential read test. However, this drive did sport some cool features such as an infrared remote control that can be used to control the functioning of the drive if you choose to install the application software that is bundled with it.

Of special mention is the performance of the drive in the random read tests.

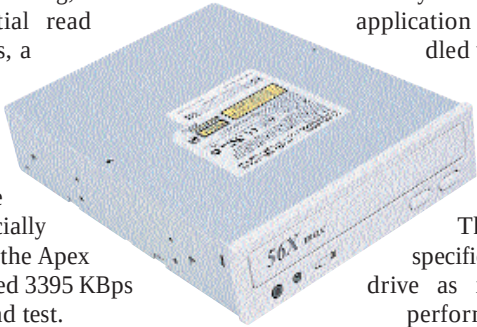
This is a very pivotal specification in a CD-ROM drive as it talks about the performance of the drive's data read assembly while accessing information from different parts of the CD-

ROM media.

While the scores in these tests may not seem very high as compared to those in the sequential read tests, they are a more realistic indication of how the drive will perform with day-to-day applications, as most access to the CD-ROM drive is random in nature (such as browsing the contents of a CD-ROM, running multimedia applications, installing applications etc).

Here, the drive that posted the best results was the **Apex CHI-56**, which logged a transfer rate of 764 KBps with an access time of just 45 ms.

If your work process predominantly involves sequential access of large data files (as in reading big image files and databas-



Apex CHI-56: it's fast in reading and transferring data

